

## Ubuntu 14.04.1 LTS is out

The Ubuntu 14.04 LTS has been around for quite some time now and most people must have upgraded it.

Another smaller update is ready – 14.04.1. Canonical

has announced that this Ubuntu update fixes many bugs and includes security updates. There is also a list of bugs and other updates in Ubuntu 14.04.1 that you might want to have a look at, in order to see the scope of this update. If you haven't upgraded to 14.04.1 yet, do so as soon as possible. It is a worthy upgrade if you use an older version of Ubuntu.



## Android Device Manager makes it easier to search for lost phones!

Google has created an update in Android Device Manager that will help the device's users better security. This latest version is called 1.3.8. It will help add a phone number in the remote locking screen, and the 'lock screen' password can also be changed. An optional message can also be set up. If the phone number is added, then a big green button will appear on the lock screen saying 'Call owner'. If the lost phone is found by someone, then the owner can be easily contacted. Earlier, only a message could be added by the users. The call-back number can be set up through the Android Device Manager app as well as the Web interface, if another Android device is not present. Both these message and call-back features are optional, though. But it's highly recommended that these features are used so that a lost phone can be easily found.



## Ubuntu's Amazon shopping feature complies with UK Data Protection Act

The independent body investigating the implementation of Ubuntu's Unity Shopping Lens feature and its compliance with the UK Data Protection Act (DPA) of 1998 has found no instances of Canonical being in breach of the act. Ubuntu's controversial 'Amazon shopping' feature has been found to be compliant with relevant data protection and privacy laws in the UK, something that was checked in response to a complaint filed by blogger Luis de Sousa last year. Notably, the feature sends out queries made in the Dash to an intermediary Canonical server, which sends it forward to Amazon. The e-commerce giant then returns product suggestions matching the query back to the Dash. The feature also sends across non-identifiable location data out in the process.



## VLC 2.1.5 has been released

VideoLAN has announced the release of the final update in the 2.1.x series of its popular open source, cross-platform media player and streaming media server: the VLC media player. VLC 2.1.5 is now available for download and installation on Windows, Mac and



Linux operating systems. Notably, the next big release for the VLC media player will be that of the 2.2.x branch. A careful look at the change log reveals that although the VLC 2.1.5 update has been released across multiple platforms, the most noticeable improvements are for OS X users. Others could consider it as a minor update.

For OS X users, VLC 2.1.5 brings about additional stability to the Qtsound capture module as well as improved support for Reti. Other notable changes (for the OS X platform) include compilation fixes for OS/2 operating systems. Also, MP3 file conversions will no longer be renamed 'raw' under the Qt interface following the update. A few decoder fixes will now benefit DxVA2 sample decoding, MAD resistance in broken MP3 streams and PGS alignment tweaks for MKV. In terms of security, the new release comes with fixes for GNU TLS and libpng as well. One should remember that VLC is a portable, free and open source, cross-platform media player and streaming media server written by the VideoLAN project that supports many audio and video compression methods and file formats. It comes with a large number of free decoding and encoding libraries, thereby eliminating the need of finding or calibrating proprietary plugins.